

IMAT MOCK EXAM 6 — "At-Level Calibration"

60 questions · 100 minutes · scoring: +1.5 correct, −0.4 wrong, 0 blank · personal target: 45/90.0 · Mock exam · answer key + worked solutions at the end

Section A - Logical Reasoning & Reading (Q1-9)

1. "Bacteria store fragments of viral DNA in ordered arrays (CRISPR loci) in their own genome. These fragments are transcribed into guide molecules used by Cas proteins, which cut any invading DNA whose sequence matches a guide. A virus escapes this defence only if it mutates the exact targeted sequence. Because the array is inherited, daughter cells of a survivor remain protected."

Which of the following is not supported by the passage?

- A) A bacterium that survives infection can pass protection on to its offspring.
- B) The defence is guided by RNA copies of stored viral sequences.
- C) Mutation of the targeted sequence can let a virus evade the defence.
- D) During infection, bacteria deliberately rewrite their own DNA to match the invading virus.
- E) The system behaves as a form of inherited immunity.

2. Five friends P, Q, R, S and T sit in a row of five seats, all facing the same direction, with seat 1 at the left end and seat 5 at the right end. Q sits immediately to the right of P. R does not sit adjacent to P. S sits at an end seat. T sits somewhere to the left of S.

Which of the following must be true?

- A) R sits between P and T.
- B) P sits at the far left.
- C) Q is not adjacent to R.
- D) T is not at an end seat.
- E) S sits at seat 5 (the far right).

3. (General knowledge) The 2026 Winter Olympic Games, held in February 2026, are hosted by:

- A) Milano and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy
- B) Venice, Italy
- C) Turin, Italy
- D) Palermo, Italy
- E) Rome, Italy

4. No reptile is warm-blooded. Some reptiles are kept as pets.

Which conclusion necessarily follows?

- A) No pet is a reptile.
- B) Some pets are warm-blooded.
- C) Some pets are not warm-blooded.
- D) Some warm-blooded animals are kept as pets.
- E) All pets are cold-blooded.

5. A clock shows 4:40. What is the angle between the hour hand and the minute hand?

- A) 40° B) 60° C) 100° D) 120° E) 260°

6. An enzyme was assayed at three pH values. Without inhibitor, the measured rates at pH 5, 7 and 9 were 20, 100 and 20 respectively. With a fixed concentration of inhibitor I present, the rates were 18, 50 and 18 at the same three pH values.

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) The enzyme is inactive at pH 9.
- B) The enzyme is most active at pH 7, and the inhibitor's relative effect is also greatest at pH 7.
- C) The enzyme's optimum lies between pH 7 and pH 9.
- D) The inhibitor reduces the rate by the same fraction at every pH.
- E) The inhibitor destroys the enzyme at acidic pH.

7. A large national audit reports that patients operated on in city hospitals have fewer post-surgical complications than patients operated on in small rural hospitals. The authors conclude that the quality of surgical care is worse in rural hospitals.

Which of the following, if true, most weakens the authors' conclusion?

- A) Rural hospitals carry out a higher proportion of emergency operations, which have higher complication rates in any setting.
- B) Rural surgeons work longer shifts than city surgeons.
- C) Some city hospitals are also teaching hospitals.
- D) City hospitals have more beds than rural hospitals.
- E) City hospitals have newer pieces of equipment on average.

8. A sequence begins 2, 4, 7, 14, 17, 34, ... following a repeating two-step rule. What is the next term?

- A) 35 B) 37 C) 51 D) 68 E) 71

9. A jacket costing 120 is discounted by 20%, and the new price is then discounted by a further 25%. What is the total percentage reduction from the original price?

- A) 35% B) 40% C) 42.5% D) 45% E) 46%

Section B - Biology (Q10-32)

10. In a dihybrid cross $AaBb \times AaBb$ with two unlinked genes (complete dominance at both), what is the probability that an offspring has genotype $AaBb$?

- A) $1/16$ B) $1/4$ C) $1/2$ D) $3/16$ E) $9/16$

11. Which cross is expected to produce a phenotypic ratio of 9:3:3:1 (two traits, complete dominance)?

- A) $Aa \times Aa$ B) $AABB \times aabb$ C) $AABb \times AaBB$ D) $AaBb \times AaBb$ E) $AaBb \times aabb$

12. A mother is a carrier of red-green colour blindness ($X^H X^h$) and the father has normal vision ($X^H Y$). What fraction of their sons is expected to be colour-blind?

- A) $3/4$ B) $1/4$ C) all of them D) 0 E) $1/2$

13. DNA replication is described as "semiconservative" because each daughter double helix:

- A) conserves half of the parent's genes
- B) conserves only the sugar-phosphate backbone of the parent
- C) is made entirely of new nucleotides
- D) contains randomly mixed old and new nucleotides within each strand
- E) contains one intact parental strand and one newly synthesised strand

14. The enzyme that synthesises an RNA strand from a DNA template during transcription is:

- A) helicase
- B) DNA polymerase
- C) reverse transcriptase
- D) RNA polymerase
- E) primase

15. Which nucleic-acid molecule physically carries the anticodon?

- A) small nuclear RNA
- B) mRNA
- C) tRNA
- D) rRNA
- E) the DNA template strand

- 16.** The α -helix of a protein is stabilised primarily by:
- A)** hydrogen bonds between backbone groups
 - B)** hydrophobic cores
 - C)** ionic bonds between consecutive amino acids
 - D)** peptide bonds between side chains
 - E)** disulfide bridges
- 17.** A point mutation changes an mRNA codon from AUG (methionine) to UGA. UGA is a stop codon. The most likely consequence is:
- A)** no change in the protein
 - B)** a frameshift downstream
 - C)** substitution of one amino acid by another
 - D)** premature termination, giving a truncated protein
 - E)** an elongated protein
- 18.** In aerobic respiration, CO_2 is released:
- A)** on the inner mitochondrial membrane, during electron transport
 - B)** in the cytosol, during glycolysis
 - C)** in the mitochondrial matrix, during pyruvate oxidation and the Krebs cycle
 - D)** in the intermembrane space, during proton pumping
 - E)** by ATP synthase
- 19.** Cyanide blocks complex IV of the electron transport chain. Why does ATP synthesis by ATP synthase then stop?
- A)** Electron transfer stops, protons are no longer pumped, and the gradient that powers ATP synthase dissipates.
 - B)** ATP synthase can run without a gradient for only a few minutes.
 - C)** ATP synthase is directly inhibited by cyanide.
 - D)** Glycolysis stops, so there is no pyruvate.
 - E)** The Krebs cycle accelerates and floods the matrix with protons.
- 20.** The main purpose of the fermentation step (lactic acid or alcoholic) in anaerobic conditions is to:
- A)** eliminate CO_2 from the cell
 - B)** synthesise NADH for the electron transport chain
 - C)** produce additional ATP beyond glycolysis
 - D)** remove glucose from the cell
 - E)** regenerate NAD^+ so glycolysis can continue
- 21.** Two inhibitors were characterised for an enzyme. With inhibitor I, the apparent K_m is $4\times$ higher and V_{max} is unchanged. With inhibitor II, K_m is unchanged and V_{max} falls to a quarter. Inhibitor I is best classified as:
- A)** non-competitive
 - B)** uncompetitive
 - C)** an allosteric activator
 - D)** competitive
 - E)** an irreversible poison
- 22.** A cell's ATP is rapidly depleted by a metabolic poison. Which transport process will fail first?
- A)** water movement through aquaporins
 - B)** diffusion of oxygen through the membrane
 - C)** osmosis
 - D)** facilitated diffusion of glucose down its gradient
 - E)** Na^+/K^+ pump activity
- 23.** The neurotransmitter released at the neuromuscular junction of vertebrates is:
- A)** acetylcholine **B)** serotonin **C)** dopamine **D)** GABA **E)** adrenaline

- 24.** The resting membrane potential of a typical vertebrate neurone is closest to:
A) –70 mV **B)** –55 mV **C)** –30 mV **D)** 0 mV **E)** +30 mV
- 25.** Vitamin K is required in the liver for the synthesis of:
A) insulin
B) albumin only
C) prothrombin and other clotting factors
D) bile salts
E) haemoglobin
- 26.** After 12 hours without drinking, blood plasma osmolality rises. Which endocrine response helps conserve water?
A) aldosterone secretion increases
B) ADH (vasopressin) secretion increases
C) insulin secretion increases
D) atrial natriuretic peptide secretion increases
E) cortisol secretion stops
- 27.** In skeletal muscle contraction, which event directly exposes the myosin-binding sites on actin?
A) calcium binding to tropomyosin
B) sodium entering the sarcoplasmic reticulum
C) calcium binding to troponin
D) ATP binding to myosin heads
E) acetylcholine binding to the sarcolemma
- 28.** Antibodies circulating in plasma are produced by:
A) platelets
B) cytotoxic T cells
C) T helper cells
D) plasma cells differentiated from B lymphocytes
E) macrophages
- 29.** A human cell has just completed DNA replication (S phase). Which chromosome/chromatid count is correct?
A) 23 chromosomes, 23 chromatids
B) 46 chromosomes, 46 chromatids
C) 46 chromosomes, 92 chromatids
D) 92 chromosomes, 92 chromatids
E) 92 chromosomes, 46 chromatids
- 30.** The walls of the pulmonary alveoli are lined by:
A) ciliated columnar epithelium
B) simple squamous epithelium
C) transitional epithelium
D) stratified squamous epithelium
E) simple cuboidal epithelium
- 31.** The light-independent reactions of photosynthesis (Calvin cycle) take place in the:
A) thylakoid lumen
B) cytosol
C) thylakoid membranes
D) mitochondrial matrix
E) stroma of the chloroplast

32. Yeast cells are switched from aerobic to strictly anaerobic conditions. Which process can still produce ATP?

- A)** fatty-acid β -oxidation feeding the electron transport chain
- B)** glycolysis
- C)** proton flow through ATP synthase
- D)** the Krebs cycle
- E)** oxidative phosphorylation

Section C - Chemistry (Q33-47)

33. What is the oxidation number of chromium in the dichromate ion, $\text{Cr}_2\text{O}_7^{2-}$?

- A)** +3 **B)** +5 **C)** +6 **D)** +7 **E)** +12

34. In the reaction $\text{Zn(s)} + 2\text{HCl(aq)} \rightarrow \text{ZnCl}_2\text{(aq)} + \text{H}_2\text{(g)}$, the reducing agent is:

- A)** Zn **B)** H^+ **C)** Cl^- **D)** H_2 **E)** Zn^{2+}

35. Which molecule has a net dipole moment (is polar overall)?

- A)** CO_2 **B)** BF_3 **C)** CCl_4 **D)** CH_3Cl **E)** CH_4

36. 0.001 M hydrochloric acid (pH 3) is diluted tenfold with water. The pH of the new solution is:

- A)** 2 **B)** 3 (unchanged) **C)** 4 **D)** 5 **E)** 7

37. What is the pH of a 0.01 M solution of NaOH at 25 °C? ($K_w = 1.0 \times 10^{-14}$)

- A)** 2 **B)** 10 **C)** 11 **D)** 12 **E)** 13

38. 3 mol of H_2 are mixed with 2 mol of O_2 and sparked: $2\text{H}_2 + \text{O}_2 \rightarrow 2\text{H}_2\text{O}$. What is the maximum amount of water formed?

- A)** 1.5 mol **B)** 2 mol **C)** 3 mol **D)** 4 mol **E)** 6 mol

39. 20 mL of a 1.5 M HCl solution is diluted with water to a final volume of 150 mL. The concentration of the diluted solution is:

- A)** 0.10 M **B)** 0.15 M **C)** 0.20 M **D)** 0.25 M **E)** 0.30 M

40. How many molecules are present in 0.50 mol of CO_2 ? ($N_a = 6.02 \times 10^{23} \text{ mol}^{-1}$)

- A)** 1.20×10^{24} **B)** 3.01×10^{22} **C)** 3.01×10^{23} **D)** 6.02×10^{23} **E)** 9.03×10^{23}

41. A sealed elastic balloon at constant pressure holds air at 27 °C. It is warmed to 327 °C. Its volume:

- A)** increases about 1.1-fold
- B)** stays the same
- C)** increases about 12-fold
- D)** halves
- E)** doubles

42. Which atom has the largest radius?

- A)** Mg **B)** K **C)** Na **D)** Cl **E)** Al

43. A white crystalline solid has a high melting point, shatters when struck, and conducts electricity only when molten or dissolved. It is most likely:

- A)** a network covalent solid such as quartz
- B)** a covalent molecular solid such as wax
- C)** a metal such as copper
- D)** graphite
- E)** an ionic compound such as NaCl

44. Ethanoic acid reacts with ethanol in the presence of a few drops of concentrated H_2SO_4 . The organic product is:
- A) ethyl ethanoate
 - B) ethanal
 - C) ethanoic anhydride
 - D) sodium ethanoate
 - E) ethanol
45. Which single observation distinguishes ethene from ethane?
- A) Both burn in air with a luminous flame.
 - B) Ethane is a gas; ethene is a liquid at room temperature.
 - C) Ethene dissolves freely in water.
 - D) Ethane contains a carbon-carbon double bond.
 - E) Ethene decolourises bromine water; ethane does not (under these conditions).
46. For the exothermic equilibrium $2\text{SO}_2 + \text{O}_2 \rightleftharpoons 2\text{SO}_3$, raising the temperature at constant pressure:
- A) increases both the rate and the equilibrium yield
 - B) decreases the rate but increases the yield
 - C) affects neither rate nor yield
 - D) increases the rate but decreases the equilibrium yield
 - E) increases the rate and leaves the yield unchanged
47. A solution contains 0.10 mol of glucose dissolved in 500 g of water. Its molality is:
- A) 0.05 mol/kg
 - B) 0.10 mol/kg
 - C) 0.20 mol/kg
 - D) 0.50 mol/kg
 - E) 2.0 mol/kg

Section D - Mathematics (Q48-54)

48. Solve the inequality $5 - 3x \geq 14$.
- A) $x < -3$
 - B) $x \leq -3$
 - C) $x \leq 3$
 - D) $x \geq 3$
 - E) $x \geq -3$
49. What is the domain of $f(x) = \sqrt{(4 - x) / (x - 2)}$?
- A) $x \leq 4$ with $x \neq 2$
 - B) $x \leq 4$ with $x \neq 4$
 - C) $x \leq 4$
 - D) $x < 4$
 - E) all real numbers
50. What is the value of $\log_3 81$?
- A) 3
 - B) 4
 - C) 9
 - D) 27
 - E) 81
51. Three fair coins are tossed. What is the probability of getting at least one head?
- A) $1/2$
 - B) $1/8$
 - C) $2/3$
 - D) $3/8$
 - E) $7/8$
52. A straight ramp 10 m long makes a 60° angle with the horizontal ground. How far along the ground does the ramp span (horizontal distance between its two ends)? ($\cos 60^\circ = 0.5$, $\sin 60^\circ = 0.87$)
- A) 2.5 m
 - B) 5 m
 - C) 6.7 m
 - D) 8.7 m
 - E) 10 m
53. If $f(x) = 2x - 3$ and $g(x) = x^2$, what is $f(g(2))$?
- A) 1
 - B) 2
 - C) 4
 - D) 5
 - E) 8
54. Simplify $(2^5 \times 2^3) \div 2^4$.
- A) 4
 - B) 8
 - C) 16
 - D) 32
 - E) 64

Section E - Physics (Q55-60)

55. A 6 V battery drives a current through a $2\ \Omega$ resistor connected in series with a parallel pair made of a $6\ \Omega$ and a $3\ \Omega$ resistor. What current flows from the battery?
- A) 0.5 A
 - B) 1.0 A
 - C) 1.5 A
 - D) 3.0 A
 - E) 6.0 A

- 56.** A kettle draws 4.6 A from a 230 V supply. Its power consumption is closest to:
A) 50 W **B)** 230 W **C)** 1060 W **D)** 2300 W **E)** 4600 W
- 57.** Equal masses of aluminium (specific heat 900 J/(kg·K)) and copper (specific heat 385 J/(kg·K)) receive the same quantity of heat. Which statement is correct?
A) Copper's temperature rises about 2.3 times more than aluminium's.
B) Both rise by the same amount.
C) Copper's temperature does not change.
D) It cannot be determined without knowing the exact heat supplied.
E) Aluminium's temperature rises more than copper's.
- 58.** A car travelling at 20 m/s brakes uniformly and comes to rest in 4.0 s. The magnitude of its deceleration is:
A) 0.2 m/s² **B)** 4 m/s² **C)** 5 m/s² **D)** 16 m/s² **E)** 20 m/s²
- 59.** A velocity-time graph shows: a linear rise from 0 to 4 m/s during the first 4 s, a constant 4 m/s for the next 4 s, then a linear fall back to 0 over the final 4 s. What total distance is covered?
A) 16 m **B)** 24 m **C)** 32 m **D)** 40 m **E)** 48 m
- 60.** A block floats stationary in water. Which statement must be true?
A) The buoyant force is zero.
B) The density of the block is greater than that of water.
C) The mass of displaced water equals the volume of the block.
D) The weight of the displaced water equals the weight of the block.
E) The block displaces a volume of water equal to its own volume.

Answer key

This key refers to the option order printed in this paper. The online app shuffles option order on every attempt, so answer letters inside the app will differ from the ones here.

1	D	2	E	3	A	4	C	5	C
6	B	7	A	8	B	9	B	10	B
11	D	12	E	13	E	14	D	15	C
16	A	17	D	18	C	19	A	20	E
21	D	22	E	23	A	24	A	25	C
26	B	27	C	28	D	29	C	30	B
31	E	32	B	33	C	34	A	35	D
36	C	37	D	38	C	39	C	40	C
41	E	42	B	43	E	44	A	45	E
46	D	47	C	48	B	49	A	50	B
51	E	52	B	53	D	54	C	55	C
56	C	57	A	58	C	59	C	60	D

Worked solutions

Each solution shows the reasoning that produces the key, and names the wrong options by their content. Letters refer to the option order printed in this paper.

Question 1 • Answer: D

The passage describes storing fragments of viral DNA and transcribing them into guide molecules; it never says the bacterium rewrites its own DNA during infection to match the invader, which would be the opposite of passive fragment storage. Protection passing to offspring, RNA guides, escape via mutation of the targeted sequence, and the inherited-immunity behaviour are each stated or directly implied in the passage.

Question 2 • Answer: E

Step 1: S sits at an end seat, seat 1 or seat 5. Step 2: T must sit somewhere to the left of S, so S cannot be at seat 1 (nothing lies to its left); S is therefore forced to seat 5, the far right, in every valid arrangement. A consistent layout such as T in seat 1, P in 2, Q in 3, R in 4, S in 5 (and equally R in 1, T in 2, P in 3, Q in 4, S in 5) shows the other claims can fail: P need not be at the far left, T can occupy an end seat, R need not sit between P and T, and Q can sit adjacent to R.

Question 3 • Answer: A

The 2026 Winter Olympic Games (6 to 22 February 2026) are hosted by Milano and Cortina d'Ampezzo in Italy, the country's third Winter Games after Cortina d'Ampezzo 1956 and Turin 2006. Turin is the tempting recall, but it hosted in 2006, not 2026.

Question 4 • Answer: C

The reptiles that are kept as pets exist by the second premise, and every reptile is not warm-blooded by the first, so at least some pets are not warm-blooded. Saying all pets are cold-blooded or that some pets are warm-blooded adds unsupported assumptions about non-reptile pets, the claim that no pet is a reptile directly contradicts the second premise, and nothing in the premises makes any warm-blooded animal a pet.

Question 5 • Answer: C

The minute hand moves 6 degrees per minute: at 40 minutes it stands at $40 \times 6 = 240^\circ$. The hour hand moves 0.5 degrees per minute: it stands at $4 \times 30 + 40 \times 0.5 = 120 + 20 = 140^\circ$. The angle between the hands is $240 - 140 = 100^\circ$. Leaving the hour hand fixed at exactly 4 o'clock (120°) ignores the 40 minutes of drift and produces the common wrong value of 120° .

Question 6 • Answer: B

Without inhibitor the rate peaks at pH 7 (100, against 20 at pH 5 and 20 at pH 9), so the optimum sits at pH 7 itself, not between 7 and 9, and the enzyme is plainly still active at pH 9. With inhibitor the fractional falls are 10 percent at pH 5 (20 to 18) and 10 percent at pH 9, but 50 percent at pH 7 (100 to 50), so the relative inhibition is greatest at pH 7 and is not a constant fraction at every pH. A residual rate of 18 out of 20 at acidic pH gives no evidence that the enzyme is destroyed there.

Question 7 • Answer: A

The argument treats the complication rate as a pure measure of surgical quality. If rural hospitals perform a higher share of emergency operations, which carry higher complication rates in any setting, the observed gap could reflect how severe the cases are rather than how good the care is, cutting the link between the evidence and the conclusion. Longer rural shifts and newer city equipment would if anything strengthen the conclusion, and bed counts or teaching status say nothing about case severity.

Question 8 • Answer: B

The rule alternates $\times 2$ and $+3$: $2 \times 2 = 4$, $4 + 3 = 7$, $7 \times 2 = 14$, $14 + 3 = 17$, $17 \times 2 = 34$. Since 34 came from doubling, the next step is $+3$, giving $34 + 3 = 37$. Doubling again to 68 would break the established alternation.

Question 9 • Answer: B

Step 1: after the 20 percent discount the price is $120 \times 0.80 = 96$. Step 2: after the further 25 percent discount it is $96 \times 0.75 = 72$. Step 3: total reduction = $(120 - 72)/120 = 48/120 = 40$ percent. Adding 20 and 25 to get 45 percent is wrong because the second discount acts on the already reduced price, not the original.

Question 10 • Answer: B

From $Aa \times Aa$ the probability of genotype Aa is $1/2$, and from $Bb \times Bb$ the probability of Bb is $1/2$; the genes are unlinked, so multiply: $1/2 \times 1/2 = 1/4$. Nine-sixteenths instead gives the chance of showing both dominant phenotypes, a different question from the double heterozygote genotype.

Question 11 • Answer: D

Only the double heterozygote cross $AaBb \times AaBb$ yields 9 both-dominant : 3 first-trait-only : 3 second-trait-only : 1 double recessive, since both genes segregate 3:1 independently. Crossing a double heterozygote with a double recessive is the testcross giving 1:1:1:1, the monohybrid $Aa \times Aa$ gives only 3:1, and crossing homozygous parents gives uniform offspring.

Question 12 • Answer: E

A son's single X chromosome always comes from the mother, because the father supplies the Y. The carrier mother passes X^H or X^h with equal probability, so exactly half of her sons inherit X^h and are colour-blind. One quarter would be the rate among all children rather than among sons, and the father's normal X passes only to daughters, so he contributes nothing to his sons' vision.

Question 13 • Answer: E

Each daughter double helix keeps one intact parental strand paired with one newly synthesised strand, because each parental strand templates its partner; Meselson and Stahl confirmed exactly this result. Molecules made entirely of new nucleotides describe the conservative model, and old and new segments randomly mixed within single strands describe the dispersive model, both of which that experiment excluded.

Question 14 • Answer: D

RNA polymerase reads the DNA template 3' to 5' and joins ribonucleotides into an RNA chain 5' to 3'; that is the defining enzyme of transcription. Reverse transcriptase copies RNA into DNA, DNA polymerase copies DNA into DNA, and helicase only unwinds the parental double helix.

Question 15 • Answer: C

The anticodon is the three-base sequence on the anticodon loop of transfer RNA, and it base-pairs with the complementary codon on messenger RNA during translation. Messenger RNA carries codons rather than anticodons, and ribosomal RNA provides the structure and catalysis of the ribosome rather than codon recognition.

Question 16 • Answer: A

The α -helix is secondary structure held together by hydrogen bonds between backbone $C=O$ and $N-H$ groups, giving the regular coiled pattern. Disulfide bridges belong to tertiary structure, and the side chains project outward from the helix without taking part in its stabilising pattern.

Question 17 • Answer: D

Changing the methionine codon into the stop codon UGA turns a sense codon into a stop signal, a nonsense mutation: the ribosome releases the chain early and the protein is truncated. Only one codon is altered, so the downstream reading frame is intact and no frameshift occurs, and premature termination shortens rather than elongates the product.

Question 18 • Answer: C

All six CO_2 per glucose are released in the mitochondrial matrix: two during pyruvate oxidation (pyruvate to acetyl-CoA) and four across the two turns of the Krebs cycle, at the decarboxylations of isocitrate and α -ketoglutarate. Glycolysis runs in the cytosol and releases no CO_2 , and the electron transport chain on the inner membrane transfers electrons to oxygen without any decarboxylation step.

Question 19 • Answer: A

ATP synthase is driven by the proton gradient that the electron transport chain builds. Blocking complex IV stops electron flow, protons are no longer pumped, and the gradient dissipates, so there is no proton-motive force left to power the synthase. Cyanide never touches ATP synthase itself, glycolysis and pyruvate supply continue, and there is no mechanism by which the Krebs cycle would accelerate and flood the matrix with protons.

Question 20 • Answer: E

Fermentation's purpose is to re-oxidise the NADH produced by glycolysis back to NAD⁺, because glycolysis halts without a fresh supply of NAD⁺. It generates no ATP itself: the entire anaerobic yield (a net 2 per glucose) comes from glycolysis, lactic acid fermentation releases no CO₂, and NADH is consumed rather than synthesised in the fermentation step.

Question 21 • Answer: D

A fourfold higher apparent K_m with V_{max} unchanged is the signature of competitive inhibition: the inhibitor competes at the active site, and a high enough substrate concentration can outcompete it, so the maximum rate survives. The other inhibitor's profile, V_{max} falling to a quarter with K_m unchanged, is non-competitive; an irreversible poison would collapse V_{max} regardless of substrate level, and an activator would not raise K_m.

Question 22 • Answer: E

The sodium-potassium pump is primary active transport and consumes ATP directly, so rapid ATP depletion stops it first. Water movement through aquaporins, oxygen diffusion, osmosis and facilitated diffusion of glucose down its gradient are all passive, gradient-driven processes that need no ATP.

Question 23 • Answer: A

At the vertebrate neuromuscular junction the motor neurone releases acetylcholine, which binds nicotinic receptors on the muscle fibre membrane and triggers contraction. Adrenaline, dopamine, GABA and serotonin act as transmitters at central or autonomic synapses, not at this junction.

Question 24 • Answer: A

A typical vertebrate neurone rests near –70 mV, set mainly by potassium leak channels. The –55 mV figure is the usual firing threshold and +30 mV the peak of the action potential, while 0 mV or –30 mV are far too positive for a resting membrane.

Question 25 • Answer: C

Vitamin K is the cofactor for γ-carboxylation of glutamate residues, which the liver needs to produce functional prothrombin (factor II) and factors VII, IX and X; without it, clotting fails. It plays no role in haemoglobin synthesis, bile salts are made independently of it, insulin is pancreatic rather than hepatic, and the restriction to albumin alone is wrong because the vitamin K products are the clotting factors.

Question 26 • Answer: B

Raised plasma osmolality, sensed by hypothalamic osmoreceptors, is the primary stimulus for increased ADH (vasopressin) secretion; ADH inserts aquaporins in the collecting duct so the kidney reabsorbs and conserves water. Aldosterone chiefly conserves sodium, atrial natriuretic peptide promotes salt and water loss (the opposite of conservation), and insulin or a halt in cortisol does not address water balance here.

Question 27 • Answer: C

Calcium released from the sarcoplasmic reticulum binds troponin, whose shape change pulls tropomyosin away from the myosin-binding sites on actin. Assigning the calcium binding to tropomyosin itself swaps the roles of the two regulatory proteins, ATP binding to myosin belongs to cross-bridge cycling, and acetylcholine acts on the sarcolemma well before this step.

Question 28 • Answer: D

Activated B lymphocytes differentiate into plasma cells, and it is these plasma cells that secrete the antibodies found in plasma. Helper T cells coordinate the response and cytotoxic T cells kill infected targets, but neither secretes antibodies, and macrophages engulf pathogens and present antigen instead.

Question 29 • Answer: C

Replication doubles the DNA while every centromere remains intact, so each of the 46 chromosomes now consists of two sister chromatids: 46 chromosomes and 92 chromatids. The chromosome count would only reach 92 at anaphase, when the sister chromatids separate and each begins to count as a chromosome.

Question 30 • Answer: B

Gas exchange demands the thinnest possible barrier, so the alveolar walls are lined by simple squamous epithelium, a single layer of flattened cells. Ciliated columnar tissue lines the conducting airways, and stratified, transitional or cuboidal linings would all be far too thick for rapid diffusion.

Question 31 • Answer: E

The Calvin cycle enzymes, including RuBisCO for carbon fixation, are dissolved in the stroma, the fluid surrounding the thylakoids. The thylakoid membranes and their lumen host the light-dependent reactions instead, and neither the mitochondrial matrix nor the cytosol has any part in photosynthesis.

Question 32 • Answer: B

Glycolysis requires no oxygen and still delivers a net 2 ATP per glucose, so it continues under strictly anaerobic conditions. With O_2 absent the electron transport chain stalls, so oxidative phosphorylation and proton flow through ATP synthase stop, NAD^+ runs short, fermentation must regenerate it, and the Krebs cycle and fatty-acid β -oxidation grind to a halt.

Question 33 • Answer: C

The sum of the oxidation numbers equals the ion charge: $2x + 7(-2) = -2$. Solving, $2x = +12$ and $x = +6$, so each chromium atom is in the +6 state. Twelve is the combined total of both chromium atoms before halving, and +7 is the state of manganese in permanganate, a different ion.

Question 34 • Answer: A

Zinc starts at oxidation number 0 and ends as Zn^{2+} (+2), losing the electrons that convert H^+ (+1) into H_2 (0). The reducing agent is the species that is itself oxidised, so zinc fills that role; H^+ is the oxidising agent, chloride ions are spectators, and H_2 and Zn^{2+} are products that cannot act as agents in the forward reaction.

Question 35 • Answer: D

CH_3Cl is tetrahedral yet asymmetric: its single C-Cl bond dipole is not balanced by the three C-H dipoles, so a net dipole remains. CO_2 (linear), BF_3 (trigonal planar), CCl_4 and CH_4 (both tetrahedral) are all symmetric, and their individual bond dipoles cancel to zero overall.

Question 36 • Answer: C

HCl is a strong acid, so the initial hydrogen ion concentration is $0.001\text{ M} = 10^{-3}\text{ M}$, hence pH 3. A tenfold dilution lowers this to 10^{-4} M , and since $pH = -\log[H^+]$, the pH rises by exactly one unit to 4. Diluting cannot make the solution more acidic (pH 2), and pH 7 would require dilution so extreme that water's own ionisation dominates the hydrogen ion concentration.

Question 37 • Answer: D

NaOH dissociates completely, so $[OH^-] = 0.01\text{ M} = 10^{-2}\text{ M}$ and $pOH = 2$. With $pH + pOH = 14$ at 25°C , $pH = 14 - 2 = 12$. The value 2 mistakes pOH for pH, and 13 would correspond to a ten times more concentrated (0.1 M) hydroxide solution.

Question 38 • Answer: C

The equation consumes 2 mol H₂ per 1 mol O₂. Three mol of H₂ needs only 1.5 mol of O₂, and with 2 mol available the hydrogen is the limiting reactant, so the water formed follows the hydrogen: the 2:2 ratio of hydrogen to water means 3 mol of H₂ yields 3 mol of H₂O. Basing the answer on the 2 mol of oxygen (4 mol of water) forgets that the hydrogen runs out first.

Question 39 • Answer: C

Dilution conserves moles of solute: $0.020 \text{ L} \times 1.5 \text{ M} = 0.030 \text{ mol}$ of HCl. Dividing by the final volume, $0.030 \div 0.150 = 0.20 \text{ M}$ (equivalently $1.5 \times 20/150$). The figure 0.15 M would follow from wrongly assuming a tenfold dilution, but 20 mL to 150 mL is a 7.5-fold dilution.

Question 40 • Answer: C

Number of molecules = moles $\times$ Avogadro's constant: $0.50 \times 6.02 \times 10^{23} = 3.01 \times 10^{23}$ molecules. Tripling that to 9.03×10^{23} counts the atoms in the sample (three per CO₂ molecule), which is not what the question asks for.

Question 41 • Answer: E

Gas laws use absolute temperature: $27^\circ\text{C} = 300 \text{ K}$ and $327^\circ\text{C} = 600 \text{ K}$. At constant pressure Charles's law gives V proportional to T , so doubling the kelvin temperature doubles the volume. Taking the ratio of the Celsius values ($327 \div 27 \approx 12$) produces the spurious twelve-fold increase.

Question 42 • Answer: B

Atomic radius increases down a group and decreases across a period. Potassium lies one full period below sodium, magnesium, aluminium and chlorine, at the left edge of its own period, so it is the largest atom listed; within the third period the ranking runs $\text{Na} > \text{Mg} > \text{Al} > \text{Cl}$.

Question 43 • Answer: E

High melting point, brittleness under impact, and conduction only when molten or dissolved are the classic signature of an ionic solid: a rigid lattice of ions that cannot carry charge until free to move, and that shatters because slipped layers bring like charges together and repel. Metals conduct as solids, molecular solids such as wax melt far too easily, and graphite conducts even as a solid through delocalised electrons.

Question 44 • Answer: A

An acid-catalysed reaction of a carboxylic acid with an alcohol is esterification: ethanoic acid + ethanol $\rightarrow$ ethyl ethanoate + water, with the concentrated H₂SO₄ acting as catalyst. Sodium ethanoate would need a base such as NaOH, ethanal is a mild oxidation product of ethanol, and the anhydride would require two acid molecules to condense rather than an acid with an alcohol.

Question 45 • Answer: E

Ethene's carbon-carbon double bond adds bromine across itself immediately, decolourising bromine water, whereas saturated ethane reacts with bromine only slowly under ultraviolet light, giving one clean visual test. Both hydrocarbons are gases at room temperature, neither dissolves freely in water, and the double bond belongs to ethene, not ethane.

Question 46 • Answer: D

Raising the temperature always increases the rate, because more molecules exceed the activation energy, so any claim of a slower reaction fails. For this exothermic equilibrium, Le Chatelier's principle shifts the position of equilibrium in the endothermic (reverse) direction at higher temperature, so the equilibrium yield of SO₃ falls. The correct combination is therefore a faster reaction with a lower yield.

Question 47 • Answer: C

Molality is defined as moles of solute per kilogram of solvent: $0.10 \text{ mol} \div 0.500 \text{ kg} = 0.20 \text{ mol/kg}$. The common slips are dividing by a solution-based mass or scaling to a full kilogram, but the definition pins the denominator to the solvent mass alone.

Question 48 • Answer: B

Rearranging: $-3x \geq 14 - 5$, so $-3x \geq 9$. Dividing by the negative number -3 reverses the inequality sign: $x \leq -3$. Failing to flip the sign gives the wrong direction, and using a strict less-than wrongly excludes $x = -3$, which satisfies the original statement exactly ($5 - 3(-3) = 14$).

Question 49 • Answer: A

Two conditions apply at once: the square root needs $4 - x \geq 0$, giving $x \leq 4$, and the denominator needs $x - 2 \neq 0$, giving $x \neq 2$. The domain is therefore $x \leq 4$ with $x \neq 2$. Overlooking the fraction misses the exclusion of 2, while excluding 4 is baseless since $x = 4$ simply makes the function equal 0.

Question 50 • Answer: B

$\log_3 81$ asks for the exponent x with $3^x = 81$; since $3 \times 3 \times 3 \times 3 = 81$, the value is 4. The figure 27 reverses the question by answering what 3^3 equals, and 81 confuses the argument of the logarithm with its value.

Question 51 • Answer: E

At least one head fails only if all three coins show tails, which has probability $(1/2)^3 = 1/8$. Subtracting, $P(\text{at least one head}) = 1 - 1/8 = 7/8$. The value $3/8$ counts exactly one head (three of the eight equally likely outcomes), a different event, and $1/8$ is the all-tails probability itself.

Question 52 • Answer: B

The ground span is the side adjacent to the 60° angle, so it uses the cosine: $10 \times \cos 60^\circ = 10 \times 0.5 = 5$ m. Using sine instead ($10 \times 0.87 = 8.7$ m) gives the ramp's vertical height, not its horizontal reach.

Question 53 • Answer: D

Composition works inside out: $g(2) = 2^2 = 4$, then $f(4) = 2 \times 4 - 3 = 8 - 3 = 5$. Reporting 8 applies only the doubling and drops the minus 3, while evaluating $g(f(2))$ in the wrong order gives $(2 \times 2 - 3)^2 = 1$.

Question 54 • Answer: C

Index laws: multiplying powers with the same base adds exponents, and dividing subtracts them. So $(2^5 \times 2^3) \div 2^4 = 2^{(5+3-4)} = 2^4 = 16$. Multiplying the exponents (2^{15}) or adding instead of subtracting on division breaks those laws.

Question 55 • Answer: C

Step 1: the parallel pair gives $1/R = 1/6 + 1/3 = 1/2$, so $R = 2 \Omega$. Step 2: this 2Ω sits in series with the separate 2Ω resistor, for a total of 4Ω . Step 3: current $= V/R = 6/4 = 1.5$ A. Dividing 6 V by the parallel pair alone (2Ω) forgets the series resistor, and summing all three resistances as if all were in series (11Ω) ignores the parallel arrangement.

Question 56 • Answer: C

Power = voltage $\times$ current $= 230 \times 4.6 = 1058$ W, closest to 1060 W. Dividing instead of multiplying gives $230 \div 4.6 = 50$, the arithmetic slip behind the smallest value offered.

Question 57 • Answer: A

From $Q = mc\Delta T$, equal heat and equal masses give ΔT proportional to $1/c$. Copper's smaller specific heat (385 against 900) means its temperature rises further, by the factor $900/385 \approx 2.3$. The actual heat supplied cancels in the ratio so it cannot be required, and aluminium, with the larger specific heat, warms less rather than more.

Question 58 • Answer: C

The deceleration magnitude is the speed change divided by the stopping time: $a = (20 - 0)/4.0 = 5$ m/s². Dividing the other way round ($4/20 = 0.2$) inverts the definition of acceleration.

Question 59 • Answer: C

Distance is the area under the velocity-time graph: rising triangle $\frac{1}{2} \times 4 \times 4 = 8$ m, flat rectangle $4 \times 4 = 16$ m, falling triangle $\frac{1}{2} \times 4 \times 4 = 8$ m, totalling 32 m (equivalently the trapezium $\frac{1}{2} \times (12 + 4) \times 4 = 32$ m). Counting only the plateau rectangle (16 m) or only the acceleration phases misses part of the motion.

Question 60 • Answer: D

A floating block is in equilibrium: the buoyant force equals its weight, and by Archimedes' principle the buoyant force equals the weight of the displaced water, so the displaced water weighs exactly what the block weighs. A displaced volume equal to the block's own volume would require matching densities and full submersion, a block density greater than water's would mean sinking, and a zero buoyant force could not balance the block's weight.